

AI_LOG.md — Smart Scheduler & Blog Development

****Course:**** CIDM 6325 — Web App Development with Django

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Overview

This log documents how AI tools (ChatGPT) were used throughout development of my **Smart Scheduler** application and **Blog Feature Set 2** for the Weeks 5–6 Unified Assignment. It provides transparency regarding the prompts used, outputs accepted, revisions made, and my critical reflections on AI's role in Django modeling, forms, and accessibility design.

1. Prompts Used

A. Django Models and Relationships

- "How do I extend my existing Shift model to connect to an Employee model using a ForeignKey?"
- "Can you show an example of a Many-to-Many relationship for staff certifications?"
- "Where do I put the related_name parameter when linking two models?"
- "Generate a simple schema diagram in text showing Shift, Employee, and Certification relationships."

B. Forms and Validation

- "How do I add a custom form in Django that checks for overlapping shifts?"
- "What does the clean() method do, and where do I put it?"
- "Can you show an example of a ModelForm with field-level validation?"
- "How do I make sure my forms are accessible (WCAG 2.2) and include clear labels and focus order?"

C. AI Disclosure and Reflection

- "Help me draft an AI_LOG.md that meets CIDM 6325 graduate-level standards."
- "How do I document prompts, accepted outputs, and rejected ones for academic integrity?"
- "What are some examples of ethical AI disclosure in technical coursework?"

2. Outputs Accepted and Integrated

■ ****Accepted****

- Drafts of Django Model and Form class structures (later refined manually).
- Template examples for clean() and save() methods with validation logic.
- Accessibility guidance from AI for adding ARIA labels and proper heading hierarchy.
- Documentation scaffolding for PRD, README, and this AI_LOG.md file.

3. Outputs Revised or Rejected

—■ ****Revised****

- Adjusted AI-suggested models to fit dispatch-center terminology (Shift, Employee, Certification).
- Simplified overly complex Many-to-Many examples to maintain clarity for MVP phase.

- Rewrote verbose AI-generated comments to concise professional tone.

■ ****Rejected****

- AI code proposing class-based mixins before models were stable.
- Suggestions to use third-party form libraries (kept within native Django).
- Early accessibility notes that didn't fully align with WCAG 2.2 color-contrast guidance.

4. Personal Revisions and Verification

■ ****My Verification Process****

- Manually validated forms in VS Code using Django's ``runserver`` and ``shell`` to confirm data entry logic.
- Implemented and tested ``clean()`` methods to ensure ``end_time > start_time`` and non-overlapping shifts.
- Confirmed model relationships migrated successfully via terminal output.
- Used Chrome's built-in accessibility tools to check tab order, contrast ratios, and label associations.
- Verified all outputs met **Understand Django** best practices for separation of concerns (Layman, Ch. 5–6).

5. Ethical Reflection on AI Assistance (~500 words)

AI tools accelerated my understanding of Django Forms and Models by providing immediate structural feedback and clear examples of best practices. When learning how to implement `clean()` validation or link models with `ForeignKey` and Many-to-Many relationships, ChatGPT served as an interactive reference, much like Layman's chapters on data flow and user input handling.

However, AI outputs often required technical discernment. For example, the model suggestions sometimes introduced unnecessary abstractions (mixins, signals) that were not suitable for a minimal viable product. I reviewed every snippet for accuracy against official Django documentation and Layman's **Understand Django**, which emphasizes code clarity and testability over complexity. Through this process, I learned to critically evaluate AI assistance, retaining responsibility for design and correctness.

AI also supported accessibility and UX refinement. Prompts about WCAG 2.2 compliance yielded practical advice—such as labeling forms, maintaining focus order, and using semantic headings—that improved usability for all users. Yet, I had to confirm compliance manually with browser dev-tools and ensure contrast met at least the AA standard. This reaffirmed that AI suggestions are aids, not guarantees.

In documentation tasks (README, PRD, AI_LOG), AI helped maintain academic and professional tone, but I personally revised every paragraph for accuracy, formatting, and alignment with WTAMU expectations. I used AI primarily as an assistant for structure, never as a source of unverified final content.

Overall, AI acted as a knowledgeable collaborator that enhanced efficiency and understanding but never replaced my analytical judgment. Responsible AI use required verification, iteration, and transparent disclosure—aligning with the ethical and academic standards defined in CIDM 6325.

6. Citations and References

- Layman, M. (2024). *Understand Django.* Chapters 5–6: “User Interaction With Forms” and “Store Data With Models.”
- WTAMU CIDM 6325 Course Modules (Weeks 5–6): Unified Assignment and Blog Feature Set 2 Guidelines.
- Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2 AA. W3C Recommendation, 2023.

7. Future AI Use Plan

For upcoming modules, I will continue to use AI for structured brainstorming and error diagnostics but maintain manual review for all production code. I plan to integrate Copilot for docstring and test-case suggestions, always disclosing AI contributions per course policy.